

Previous Year Questions

QUES

2 Mark Questions

Q1: What was the significance of Frédéric Sorrieu's prints of 1848? (2 Marks)

- Frédéric Sorrieu, a French artist, created a series of four prints in 1848 visualizing his dream of a world made up of 'democratic and social republics'.
- These prints are significant as they were among the first visual expressions of the idea of a 'nation-state' and symbolised the ideals of liberty and equality for various peoples of Europe and America.

Q2: What were the main political and constitutional changes brought about by the French Revolution? (2 Marks)

- The French Revolution led to the transfer of sovereignty from the monarchy to a body of French citizens.
- It established the idea that the people would constitute the nation and shape its destiny, moving towards a system of government by the people.

Q3: Explain the concept of 'la patrie' and 'le citoyen' in the context of the French Revolution. (2 Marks)

- The ideas of 'la patrie' (the fatherland) and 'le citoyen' (the citizen) were introduced by the French revolutionaries.
- These concepts emphasised the notion of a united community enjoying equal rights under a constitution and created a sense of collective identity among the French people.

Q4: What was the Napoleonic Code and what were its key provisions? (2 Marks)

- The Napoleonic Code, or the Civil Code of 1804, was a set of laws introduced by Napoleon.
- It abolished privileges based on birth, established equality before the law, and secured the right to property, standardising the legal system in France and its territories.

Q5: How did the Habsburg Empire present a challenge to the idea of a 'nation-state'? (2 Marks)

- The Habsburg Empire was a 'patchwork' of many different regions and peoples, with diverse ethnic and linguistic groups.
- These groups, such as Germans, Magyars, and Poles, did not share a common collective identity, making it a multi-national dynastic empire rather than a nation-state.

Q6: Who were the 'liberal nationalists' and what were their main political demands? (2 Marks)

- Liberal nationalists were members of the educated middle class, including industrialists, businessmen, and professionals.
- Politically, they demanded government by consent, the end of autocracy, and a constitution with a representative government.

Q7: What was the main outcome of the Treaty of Vienna of 1815? (2 Marks)

- The Treaty of Vienna was convened to undo the changes brought about by the Napoleonic Wars.
- Its main objective was to restore the monarchies that Napoleon had overthrown and to create a new conservative order in Europe.

Q8: What is the difference between a 'nation-state' and a 'dynastic empire'? (2 Marks)

- A nation-state is one where the majority of its citizens, and not just the rulers, come to develop a shared sense of identity and common history.
- A dynastic empire, like the Habsburg Empire, is a multi-national realm where different ethnic groups are bound together by a common allegiance to a ruler, not a shared cultural identity.

Q9: Why did the initial enthusiasm for French rule in the conquered territories turn into hostility? (2 Marks)

- Initial enthusiasm faded because the administrative reforms under Napoleon did not come with political freedom.
- People in the conquered territories were alienated by increased taxation, censorship, and forced conscription into the French armies.

Q10: Why were the conservatives of 1815 not in favour of a complete return to the pre-revolutionary society? (2 Marks)

- Conservatives had seen from Napoleon's changes that modernisation could actually strengthen traditional institutions.
- They believed that a modern army, efficient bureaucracy, and a dynamic economy could bolster the autocratic monarchies they wished to preserve.

3 Mark Questions

Q11: How did the French revolutionaries create a sense of collective identity among the French people? (3 Marks)

- The French revolutionaries introduced several measures to foster a collective identity. They promoted the ideas of 'la patrie' (the fatherland) and 'le citoyen' (the citizen), which emphasised a united community with equal rights under a constitution. This created a feeling of belonging and shared purpose.
- A new French tricolour flag was adopted to replace the royal standard, serving as a powerful symbol of the new nation. The Estates General was renamed the National Assembly, and new hymns were composed, oaths were taken, and martyrs were commemorated in the name of the nation.
- A centralised administrative system with uniform laws for all citizens was established. Furthermore, internal customs duties and dues were abolished, and a uniform system of weights and measures was adopted. French, as spoken in Paris, became the common language, discouraging regional dialects to promote national unity.

Q12: Explain the role of Napoleon Bonaparte in the making of nationalism, both positively and negatively. (3 Marks)

- On the positive side, Napoleon's administrative reforms, especially the Civil Code of 1804 (Napoleonic Code), laid the groundwork for a modern nation-state. This code abolished birth-based privileges, established equality before the law, and secured the right to property. He also simplified administrative divisions, abolished the feudal system, and improved transport and communication systems, which helped in the spread of nationalist ideals and economic unity.
- He also inadvertently spread the ideas of nationalism to other parts of Europe. By carrying out the revolutionary principles in administration and showing that a single

unified law code could work, he inspired similar movements in places like Germany and Italy. The French armies carried the message of liberty and equality abroad.

- On the negative side, Napoleon's rule was seen as an autocratic and oppressive regime in the conquered territories. The increased taxation, censorship, and forced conscription into his armies to conquer the rest of Europe generated widespread hostility. This oppression paradoxically fuelled a new sense of nationalism among the people of these occupied countries, who began to unite against French domination to gain their own national sovereignty.

Q13: Describe the political and social conditions of Europe in the mid-18th century. How did they differ from the idea of a 'nation-state'? (3 Marks)

- In the mid-18th century, Europe was not composed of the 'nation-states' we see today. The continent was divided into monarchical kingdoms, duchies, and cantons. These regions were ruled by autocratic monarchs who governed over diverse populations.
- Socially, there was no shared sense of collective identity or common culture among the peoples. For instance, the Habsburg Empire was a 'patchwork' of regions like the German-speaking Alpine region, the Magyar-speaking Hungary, and the Polish-speaking Galicia. The only thing that united these diverse groups was a common allegiance to the emperor.
- This structure stood in stark contrast to the idea of a nation-state, which is defined by a shared sense of common identity, language, and culture among a majority of its citizens. The 18th-century European states were multi-national dynastic empires, not unified nations with a shared destiny and history.

Q14: What were the key features of the new conservatism that emerged after 1815? How did it oppose liberal nationalism? (3 Marks)

- The new conservatism that emerged after 1815 was driven by a belief in preserving traditional institutions of state and society, such as the monarchy, the Church, and social hierarchies. Unlike earlier conservatives, they were open to some modernisation, but only if it could strengthen these traditional structures. They believed a modern army, efficient bureaucracy, and dynamic economy could bolster autocratic monarchies.
- Conservative regimes were autocratic and did not tolerate criticism or dissent. They sought to curb any activities that questioned their authority and often imposed censorship laws to control the press, books, plays, and songs. This was a direct attack on the liberal

demand for freedom of the press and expression.

- Conservatism was fundamentally opposed to the core ideals of liberal nationalism. While liberals demanded government by consent and a representative government based on a constitution, conservatives sought to restore and maintain monarchical power. The Treaty of Vienna, an embodiment of this conservatism, aimed to undo the changes of the French Revolution and re-establish the old order, which was the very antithesis of liberal nationalist aspirations for national unity and self-determination.

Q15: What did 'liberalism' mean for the new middle class in 19th-century Europe? Explain its economic and political aspects. (3 Marks)

- For the new middle classes, liberalism meant freedom for the individual and equality of all before the law. This was a direct challenge to the privileges and hierarchies of the old aristocratic order. Politically, liberalism stood for government by consent, demanding a constitution and a representative government through a parliament. However, this equality was not universal; the right to vote was often limited to property-owning men, excluding women and non-propertied men.
- In the economic sphere, liberalism advocated for the freedom of markets and the abolition of state-imposed restrictions on the movement of goods and capital. For businessmen and merchants, this meant a demand for a unified economic territory, where they could move goods without customs duties or different currency systems. They sought to get rid of the numerous customs barriers and different currencies that existed across the German states, which hindered their economic activities.
- The desire for a unified economic space led to the formation of the 'Zollverein' or customs union in 1834. This union abolished tariff barriers and reduced the number of currencies from over thirty to just two, facilitating trade and demonstrating the economic power of liberalism. This economic unity became a powerful force for the eventual political unification of Germany.

Q16: How did the Treaty of Vienna of 1815 try to reverse the changes brought about by Napoleon? State any three measures taken. (3 Marks)

- The Treaty of Vienna, drawn up by the European powers, aimed to undo most of the changes that had occurred in Europe during the Napoleonic wars. The first measure was the restoration of the Bourbon dynasty to power in France, which had been deposed during the French Revolution.

- Secondly, France lost the territories it had annexed under Napoleon. A series of new states were set up on the boundaries of France to prevent future French expansion. For example, the Kingdom of the Netherlands, including Belgium, was established in the north, and Genoa was added to Piedmont in the south.
- Thirdly, Prussia was given important new territories on its western frontiers, and Austria was given control of Northern Italy. This reorganisation of territories was meant to establish a new balance of power in Europe and restore the monarchical order that had been disrupted by Napoleon.

Q17: What was the significance of the new middle class in the rise of nationalism in Europe? (3 Marks)

- The new middle class, comprising industrialists, businessmen, and professionals, played a pivotal role in the rise of nationalism. Their growth was a direct result of industrialisation in Western and Central Europe. This class was educated and liberal-minded, and they were the main proponents of the idea of a nation-state.
- They championed the ideals of liberalism—individual freedom, equality before the law, and government by consent. They saw a unified nation-state as the only solution to the problems of a divided Europe, where different regions were controlled by autocratic rulers and were economically fragmented.
- Economically, they demanded freedom of markets and the abolition of state-imposed restrictions on the movement of goods and capital. They understood that a unified territory with uniform laws, standardised weights and measures, and a common currency would greatly facilitate trade. The Zollverein, a customs union, was a result of their efforts and became a crucial step towards German political unification, demonstrating the middle class's ability to drive the nationalist movement forward.

Q18: Trace the various changes brought about by the French revolutionaries to create a sense of collective identity among the French people. (3 Marks)

- The French revolutionaries introduced several measures to foster a sense of collective identity. The ideas of 'la patrie' (the fatherland) and 'le citoyen' (the citizen) were introduced to emphasise a united community with equal rights under a constitution.
- A new French tricolour flag was chosen to replace the old royal standard. The Estates General was elected by citizens and was renamed the National Assembly. New hymns

were composed and oaths were taken to honour the nation. A centralised administrative system was established to create uniform laws for all citizens, and internal customs duties were abolished.

- To further unite the nation, the revolutionaries promoted French as the common language, as it was spoken and written in Paris, and discouraged regional dialects. These measures created a shared national culture and identity that went beyond allegiance to a monarch, a fundamental shift that paved the way for the nation-state.

Q19: What changes did Napoleon introduce in the territories under his control? How did they affect the people? (3 Marks)

- In the territories under his control, Napoleon introduced the Civil Code of 1804 (Napoleonic Code), which brought significant changes. It abolished all privileges based on birth, established equality before the law, and secured the right to property. This modern legal system was a major step away from the old feudal order.
- He simplified administrative divisions, abolished the feudal system, and freed peasants from serfdom and manorial dues. In towns, guild restrictions were removed, and transport and communication systems were improved. These changes were initially welcomed by peasants, artisans, workers, and businessmen, who saw them as a newfound freedom and an opportunity for economic growth. The introduction of uniform laws and standardised weights and measures was particularly beneficial for merchants.
- However, the advantages of these administrative changes were soon overshadowed by political disadvantages. Napoleon's rule was autocratic, and people were subjected to increased taxation, censorship, and forced conscription into the French armies to fuel his expansionist wars. This led to widespread hostility and opposition, as people realised that political freedom was not part of the deal.

Q20: Discuss the main objectives of the European powers who met at Vienna in 1815. Who was the host of this congress? (3 Marks)

- The main objective of the European powers—Britain, Russia, Prussia, and Austria—who met at the Congress of Vienna in 1815 was to draw up a settlement for Europe after the defeat of Napoleon. The host of this congress was the Austrian Chancellor, Duke Metternich. The primary goal was to undo most of the changes that had come about in Europe during the Napoleonic wars and to restore the old order.

- They aimed to restore the monarchies that Napoleon had overthrown and to create a new conservative order. For example, the Bourbon dynasty was restored to power in France. They also sought to prevent future French expansion by setting up a series of states on the boundaries of France, such as the Kingdom of the Netherlands, which included Belgium, and adding Genoa to Piedmont.
- Additionally, the treaty was designed to establish a new balance of power in Europe, ensuring that no single power could dominate the continent again. Territories were redistributed among the victorious powers, such as Prussia receiving new land on its western frontiers and Austria gaining control of Northern Italy. The German confederation of 39 states created by Napoleon was, however, left untouched, reflecting a pragmatic approach to some of the changes.

5 Mark Questions

Q21: Explain the role of the French Revolution as the 'first clear expression of nationalism' and how its ideas spread to other parts of Europe. (5 Marks)

- The French Revolution of 1789 is widely regarded as the first clear expression of nationalism. Before the revolution, France was ruled by an absolute monarch, and the people were subjects, not citizens. The revolution marked a fundamental shift by transferring sovereignty from the monarchy to a body of French citizens, thereby declaring that it was the people who would henceforth constitute the nation and shape its destiny. This was a radical idea that a nation was a community of people, not a collection of territories owned by a ruler.
- To foster a sense of collective identity, the revolutionaries introduced several measures. The ideas of 'la patrie' (the fatherland) and 'le citoyen' (the citizen) were used to create a sense of a united community enjoying equal rights. A new French tricolour flag was adopted, and new hymns were composed to celebrate the nation. A centralised administrative system with uniform laws was established, and internal customs duties were abolished. The promotion of French as the common language also contributed to this sense of unity.
- The French Revolutionaries did not limit their vision to France alone. They declared that it was the mission of the French nation to liberate the peoples of Europe from despotism and help them become nations. This ideal was carried abroad by the French armies. As

the news of the revolution spread, students and other educated middle-class people in other European cities began setting up Jacobin clubs, inspired by the events in France. These clubs acted as a channel for revolutionary ideas.

- The French armies, which moved into places like Holland, Belgium, Switzerland, and Italy in the 1790s, carried the idea of nationalism with them. The revolutionary wars began to spread the concept of a nation-state beyond France's borders. Even though Napoleon's rule was autocratic, his administrative reforms (the Napoleonic Code) simplified systems and standardised laws, which were a blueprint for the modern nation-state. This, in turn, inspired nationalist movements in other countries, as people sought to create their own unified and independent nations, either in imitation of France or in opposition to French rule.

Q22: Describe the composition of European society during the mid-18th century. How did the emergence of a new middle class challenge this social structure? (5 Marks)

- In the mid-18th century, European society was broadly divided into two main classes: the landed aristocracy and the peasantry. The aristocracy was the dominant class, both socially and politically. They owned vast estates in the countryside and also townhouses. They were united by a common way of life that cut across regional divisions, often speaking French for diplomacy and in high society. Their families were frequently connected by ties of marriage. The peasantry formed the vast majority of the population. They were either tenant farmers or small landholders, and in Eastern and Central Europe, they were largely tied to the land as serfs.
- This traditional social structure was deeply hierarchical, with power concentrated in the hands of the landed aristocracy and the monarchy. There was little to no concept of a unified national identity; instead, allegiances were based on loyalty to a ruler or a specific region. The diverse populations within dynastic empires like the Habsburg Empire had no shared culture or language, and they were not a unified political entity.
- The emergence of a new middle class in the late 18th and 19th centuries challenged this traditional order. This class emerged as a result of industrialisation in Western and Central Europe. It was composed of industrialists, businessmen, and professionals such as doctors and teachers. Unlike the aristocracy, their wealth and social standing were based on their economic activities rather than on land ownership or birth. This new class was educated and had a liberal outlook. They were the main proponents of nationalism

and the idea of a nation-state.

- The middle class believed in individual freedom and equality before the law, which directly challenged the birth-based privileges of the aristocracy. Politically, they demanded government by consent and a representative government. Economically, they sought freedom of markets and the abolition of state-imposed restrictions, which were major obstacles to their business interests. Their demands for a unified economic territory and a single currency were powerful forces that mobilised them towards the goal of creating a unified nation-state, thereby fundamentally changing the political and social landscape of Europe.

Q23: Examine the provisions of the Treaty of Vienna of 1815. What were its main aims and what was its impact on Europe? (5 Marks)

- The Treaty of Vienna was a comprehensive settlement drawn up in 1815 by the major European powers—Britain, Russia, Prussia, and Austria—who had collectively defeated Napoleon. The congress was hosted by the Austrian Chancellor, Duke Metternich. The primary aim was to undo the changes brought about by the Napoleonic Wars and to restore the old monarchical order.
- One of the key provisions was the restoration of the Bourbon dynasty to power in France, which had been overthrown during the French Revolution. This was a clear move to reinstate the principle of monarchical legitimacy. Secondly, France lost the territories it had annexed under Napoleon, and a series of states were set up on its borders to prevent future expansion. For instance, the Kingdom of the Netherlands (including Belgium) was created in the north, and Genoa was added to Piedmont in the south. This was done to create a buffer zone around France.
- To ensure a balance of power, territories were redistributed among the victorious powers. Prussia was given significant new lands on its western frontiers, and Austria was granted control of Northern Italy. In the east, Russia received a part of Poland, while Prussia was given a portion of Saxony. Notably, the German confederation of 39 states that had been set up by Napoleon was left untouched, as it was considered a pragmatic compromise and a tool for potential future control.
- The impact of the Treaty of Vienna was significant. It established a new conservative order in Europe, which was autocratic and opposed to liberal ideals. These regimes imposed censorship laws and suppressed dissent. However, the legacy of the French

Revolution and Napoleon's reforms could not be erased. The ideals of liberalism and nationalism continued to inspire revolutionaries and led to underground secret societies. The actions of the conservatives, such as their attempts to suppress freedom of the press, only strengthened the resolve of liberal-nationalists and laid the groundwork for future revolutions in the 19th century, which ultimately led to the very national unification the conservatives had tried to prevent.

Q24: How did the Napoleonic Code streamline the administrative system? Explain how this created a more efficient state. (5 Marks)

- The Napoleonic Code, formally known as the Civil Code of 1804, was a landmark in modern legal and administrative history. Although Napoleon had destroyed democracy in France, he incorporated revolutionary principles into his administrative system to make it more rational and efficient. This code did away with all privileges based on birth, a major blow to the old aristocratic order. It established equality before the law and secured the right to property, creating a legal framework that was consistent for all citizens.
- The code was not limited to France; it was exported to the regions under French control, such as the Dutch Republic, Switzerland, Italy, and Germany. In these areas, Napoleon simplified the complex administrative divisions that had existed for centuries, replacing them with a more coherent system. He abolished the feudal system, freeing peasants from serfdom and the burdensome manorial dues they had to pay to their landlords. This not only improved the lives of the peasantry but also made the economy more dynamic by freeing up a large workforce.
- In towns, guild restrictions were removed. These guilds had long controlled who could work in certain trades, and their removal allowed for greater competition and innovation. Furthermore, Napoleon improved transport and communication systems, which were crucial for both economic and military purposes. These reforms made it easier to move goods and people across regions, fostering economic integration.
- For the new class of businessmen and merchants, these changes were particularly welcome. The introduction of uniform laws, standardised weights and measures, and a common national currency greatly facilitated the movement and exchange of goods and capital. For instance, a merchant traveling from one region to another would no longer have to deal with dozens of different currencies or measures. This administrative and

economic streamlining created a more efficient state and a more predictable environment for commerce, ultimately paving the way for a more unified national economy and contributing to the idea of a unified nation-state.

Q25: What were the main ideas of liberalism in 19th-century Europe? How did it lead to the rise of nationalism? (5 Marks)

- Liberalism was a political and economic ideology that dominated the thought of the new educated middle class in 19th-century Europe. The word 'liberalism' is derived from the Latin word 'liber', meaning free. For the new middle classes, liberalism stood for freedom for the individual and equality of all before the law. This was a powerful idea that directly challenged the aristocratic privileges and social hierarchies of the old order, which were based on birth and status.
- Politically, liberalism meant government by consent. Liberals advocated for a constitution and a representative government through a parliament. This was a direct reaction to the autocratic rule of monarchs and the conservative regimes that had been re-established after the defeat of Napoleon. However, this political liberalism was not fully democratic. In the 19th century, the right to vote was often restricted to property-owning men, thereby excluding women and non-propertied men from political participation.
- In the economic sphere, liberalism stood for the freedom of markets and the abolition of state-imposed restrictions on the movement of goods and capital. For the new business classes, this was a crucial demand. In places like the German-speaking regions, a merchant travelling from Hamburg to Nuremberg had to pass through numerous customs barriers, each with its own duties and currencies. This fragmented economic landscape was a major obstacle to growth.
- The desire for a unified economic territory and a national market became a powerful driving force for the unification of nations. The establishment of the Zollverein (customs union) in 1834, which abolished tariff barriers and reduced the number of currencies, was a clear manifestation of this economic liberalism. By creating a unified economic space, it paved the way for political unification. The struggle for these liberal ideals—a government based on a constitution, equal laws, and a unified economy—was a central theme in the rise of nationalism, as people began to see that these goals could only be achieved within the framework of a modern, unified nation-state.